

Uddannelsesmuligheder efter folkeskolen



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Ethiopia. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a really thoughtful question — and it's great that you're already reflecting on your future! I'll break this down to help you consider your options and what might fit you best. Since you've just finished primary school (in Denmark, that's *folkeskolen*), your next step is usually some form of **youth education (ungdomsuddannelse)**. Here's an overview:

🎓 Your main options after primary school

In Denmark, there are two main types of youth education:

1 General upper secondary education (gymnasiale uddannelser)

If you like academic subjects, want a broad education, and might want to go to university later, this could suit you. The main options are:

- **STX** (*studentereksamen*) – General academic subjects (sciences, languages, humanities, arts).
- **HHX** – Focus on business, economics, international trade.
- **HTX** – Focus on technical and science subjects (technology, IT, engineering, natural sciences).
- **HF** – A 2-year general education program, often for slightly older students or those who want a shorter upper secondary program.

2 Vocational education and training (erhvervsuddannelse)

If you prefer learning by doing, and want to move into a trade or practical job (but can still go to university later if you want), you can choose this. Some examples:

- Carpentry, plumbing, electrician
- Healthcare assistant, childcare worker
- Chef, hairdresser
- IT support, media production

😐 How to choose?

Here are some questions to ask yourself:

- Do you enjoy academic subjects like Danish, English, math, sciences, or history?

- Are you interested in practical work, creating things, or working hands-on?
- Do you see yourself going to university in the future, or do you want to get into the workforce sooner?
- Are there particular subjects or careers that excite you — for example, business, design, technology, healthcare, or art?

Other considerations

- ✓ Since you're fluent in Danish and have a multicultural background, you might have strengths in languages, communication, or international perspectives. This could be valuable in fields like international business (HHX), diplomacy (STX), teaching, or social work.
- ✓ If you want flexibility (for example, you're still figuring out your interests), **STX** is a solid general choice because it keeps many doors open.
- ✓ If you're drawn to a specific field (like IT, engineering, or business), **HTX** or **HHX** could help you focus earlier.
- ✓ If you're eager to work with your hands or get a job faster (while still having the option for further study later), **vocational education** might suit you.

My recommendation

- ➔ **If you're unsure:** Consider **STX** because it gives you broad options and time to discover your strengths.
- ➔ **If you know you like technology/science:** **HTX** could match your interests.
- ➔ **If you're interested in business or economics:** **HHX** is a great choice.
- ➔ **If you're eager for a practical career:** Explore **erhvervsuddannelse** — maybe even start with an introductory basic course (grundforløb) to try out a trade.

What you can do now

- Talk to your school counselor (*uddannelsesvejleder*) — they can help you match your interests with options.
- Visit **open house events** (*åbent hus*) at local gymnasiums or vocational schools to get a feel for the environment.
- Try to do a short internship (*praktik*) or job shadowing if possible.

If you tell me more about what subjects or activities you enjoy, I can help you narrow it down even further! 🚀